BeReal:

A Parent's Plain-English Guide

BeReal is a social media app built around sharing one unfiltered photo a day. It encourages users to post a real-time snapshot of their life with no editing. It feels safer than other platforms — but there are still important risks parents should understand.

20M+ daily users globally

13+ minimum age (not enforced)

FOCUS on "authentic" sharing

CYBER SAFETY GUY

WHAT'S INSIDE

01 What BeReal is
02 How it works
03 Safety features
04 Controls & settings
05 The risks
06 Starting the conversation

cybersafetyguy.com | 100% of subscription income donated to Childline (NSPCC)

01 WHAT IS BEREAL?

BeReal is a photo-sharing app where users post one unedited photo per day at a random time.

Daily notification
Everyone posts at the same random time.

Dual camera
Front and back camera used at once.

No filters
Photos are unedited and "real".

Friends-only feed
Content mainly from people you know.

Discovery (optional)
Public posts from strangers if enabled.

WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND

1. **"Real" does not mean risk-free**
   Posting real life can expose more than intended.
2. **Location clues are easy to miss**
   Backgrounds can reveal where your child is.
3. **Social pressure still exists**
   Daily posting can feel compulsory.

BY THE NUMBERS

1
POST PER DAY
Designed to reduce overuse.

2
MINUTE WINDOW
Encourages instant, unedited sharing.

LATE
LATE POSTS ARE LABELLED
Creates pressure to post on time.

02 SAFETY FEATURES / SETTINGS

WHAT EXISTS

- Friends-only posting by default
- Optional private account
- Ability to disable public discovery

WHAT TO CHANGE

- Turn Discovery OFF (no public posts)
- Limit friends to people they know in real life
- Disable location sharing (if enabled)

03 STEP-BY-STEP SAFETY GUIDE

1. **Set account to private**
   Ensure only approved friends can see posts.
2. **Review friend list together**
   Remove unknown or unnecessary contacts.
3. **Turn off Discovery**
   Prevent posts being visible to strangers.
4. **Talk about surroundings**
   Avoid sharing location clues (school, home).
5. **Normalise skipping a post**
   Missing a day is okay.

04 THE RISKS WORTH KNOWING

Location exposure
Backgrounds reveal home, school, routines and places you visit.

Peer pressure
Pressure to post daily and "fit in".

Unintended sharing
Photos capture more than expected in the moment.

Stranger visibility
If Discovery is enabled, anyone can see your posts.

False sense of safety
"Friends only" can still include the wrong people.

05 THE 10-MINUTE CONVERSATION

- What do you usually post on BeReal? Can I see one?
- Do you know everyone on your friends list?
- Have you ever posted something and then regretted it?
- Do you feel pressure to post every day?
- What would you do if someone you didn't know added you?

Key principle: Curiosity before concern. No pressure, no judgement. Help them think before they post.

06 IF THINGS GO WRONG

STAY CALM & GATHER EVIDENCE

- Screenshot posts or interactions.
- Save anything concerning.

REPORT & SEEK HELP

- Remove/block users.
- Report through the app.
- Speak to school if peers are involved.

CLOSING THOUGHT

BeReal is designed to be simpler and more authentic than other platforms. That helps — but it doesn't remove the need for awareness, boundaries, and open conversations.

Childline support: 0800 1111 | childline.org.uk

Staying on top of digital safety is hard work, but you are not alone.